

RICA CRAIG

ri.craigrica@gmail.com • [LinkedIn](#) • [Portfolio](#) • New York, NY

SKILLS

UX / Design: Human-Centered Design, Interaction Design, Visual Design, Low to High Fidelity Prototyping, Design Systems, User Research, Usability Testing, Storyboarding, Information Architecture, Data Visualization,

AI / Engineering: LLM integration, RAG pipelines, multi-tool agents, Generative AI tools, Vibecoding

Tools: Figma, monday.com, Claude Code

Engineering: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Python, R, SQL, GitHub, Agile

EXPERIENCE

IBM | Platform Engineer | New York, NY Feb 2026 to Present

- Designed and prototyped a watsonx Orchestrate agent as a proof of concept for a financial services client, letting end users query IBM Planning Analytics data and surface forecasting insights through natural language in Microsoft Teams without needing to navigate the platform's underlying complexity; applied human-centered design principles to shape agent interaction flows end-to-end.
- Collaborated with engineers to resolve critical bottlenecks in a RAG pipeline built for a 200+ page financial report, enabling end users to parse complex financial information significantly faster while aligning the technical solution with user experience requirements.

IBM | Customer Success Manager | New York, NY Aug 2024 to Jan 2026

- Partnered with clients, technical sales, and Expert Labs to define use case requirements for IBM's AI portfolio (watsonx Orchestrate, watsonx.ai), translating complex system capabilities into user-centered product strategies and clear interaction models.
- Owned end-to-end product design and iteration of a watsonx Orchestrate procurement demo, from problem definition through prototyping and stakeholder buy-in, leveraging information architecture and interaction design to drive measurable adoption.
- Synthesized continuous client feedback to refine and iterate proof-of-concept demos, ensuring closer alignment with each client's use case needs and strengthening client retention across financial services accounts.

DoSomething | Product & Engineering Intern | New York, NY Jul to Aug 2023

- Conducted end-to-end user research (interviews, affinity diagrams, personas, usability testing) to redesign sign-in/sign-up flows for a 5M+ member platform, improving program completion rates.
- Produced low-to-high fidelity wireframes, visual design mockups, and interactive Figma prototypes across multiple testing rounds; collaborated with developers and product management to ship validated designs aligned to measurable user behavior goals.

Cornell University | AI Research Assistant | Ithaca, NY Feb to May 2023

- Ran competitive analysis and usability testing of AI image generators; synthesized insights into actionable design recommendations and data visualizations for research stakeholders.

EDUCATION

Cornell University | B.S. Information Science | Minors: Business, Law & Society | GPA: 3.94 December 2023

Relevant Coursework: Human-Computer Interaction Design • Intermediate Web Development • iOS Development • Project Management

CodePath | Applications of AI Engineering (AI201) Present

- Building end-to-end AI systems including RAG pipelines, multi-tool agents, safety guardrails, and content classifiers using Python, FastAPI, LangChain, and ChromaDB.
- Using Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, and vibecoding workflows as core development and prototyping tools throughout the curriculum, directly mirroring AI-first design workflows in production environments.

DESIGN PORTFOLIO

Ithaca Hunt App | **DoSomething Redesign** | **Evergreen App** | *Figma, HTML/CSS/JS* 2022 to 2023

- Led UX research cycles (interviews, affinity diagrams, personas, usability testing), visual design, and low-to-high fidelity Figma prototyping across 4+ rounds; implemented select designs in HTML/CSS/JS. Full case studies at [portfolio](#).